ALIGNED COMPARISON

Which options meet the launch limits?

Limits: 6 weeks · €80k initial budget

Criterion	Build	Buy	Partner
Lead time · weeks	12	4	6
Initial cost · €k	120	60	80
Control	Full	Limited	Shared

Buy and Partner meet both limits; control remains a trade-off.

Works well when

Use shared rows when supplied alternatives already share criteria and the audience needs to compare their trade-offs.

Limitation

Poor fit when options are judged on unrelated criteria or the descriptions need long narrative text.

One-time cost and lead-time estimates. Lifetime cost is outside this comparison. · Fictional service-launch data · layout examples only

Read aligned comparison guidance ↗

WHOLE AND PARTS

Where does the launch budget go?

€200k planned launch budget



Product	Operations	Research	Contingency
€100k · 50%	€50k · 25%	€30k · 15%	€20k · 10%

Works well when

Use a proportional bar when supplied exclusive parts add up to a known whole and the audience asks about allocation.

Limitation

Poor fit when categories overlap or the total is unknown; precise ranking of similar parts is clearer with aligned bars.

Exclusive categories cover the planned budget. This is an allocation, not actual spending. · Fictional service-launch data · layout examples only

Read whole and parts guidance ↗

NESTED GROUPS

What belongs in each workstream?

Launch programme · workstream membership

Experience

- Research
- Design

Delivery

- Engineering
- Operations

Works well when

Use containment when supplied membership gives each item one parent and the audience needs to see the groups.

Limitation

Poor fit for shared membership, cross-group dependencies, or inferred reporting authority.

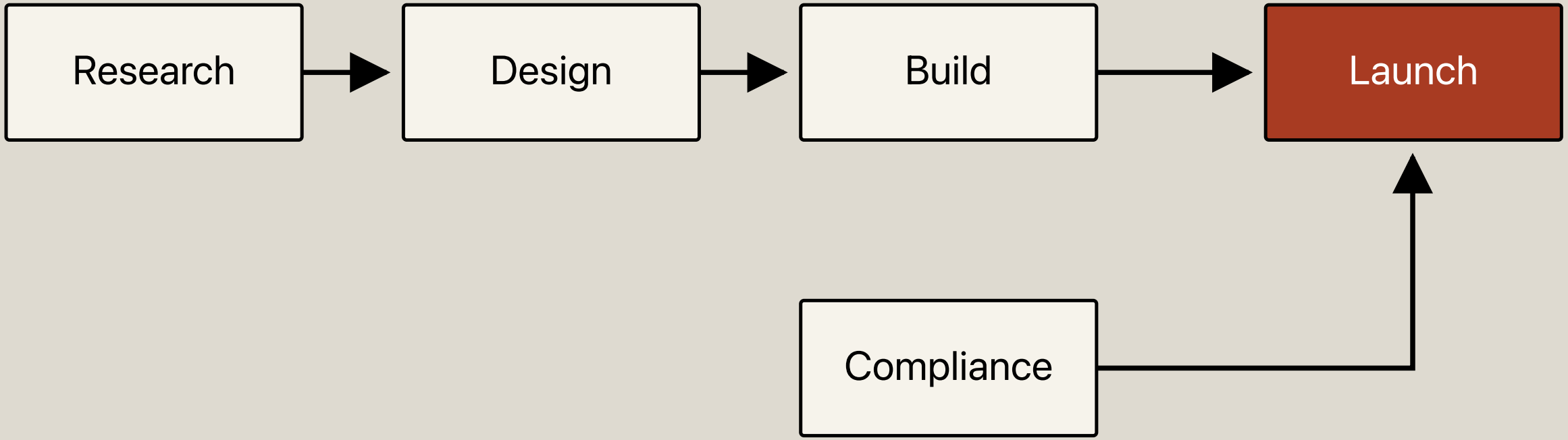
Membership is the relationship shown. Equal areas do not indicate team size or capacity. · Fictional service-launch data · layout examples only

Read nested groups guidance ↗

DIRECTED DEPENDENCIES

What must finish before launch?

Arrows mean “must finish before”



Works well when

Use a small directed diagram when supplied prerequisites and their forks or joins matter.

Limitation

Poor fit for dense networks or questions about dates and durations; use a timeline when timing is known.

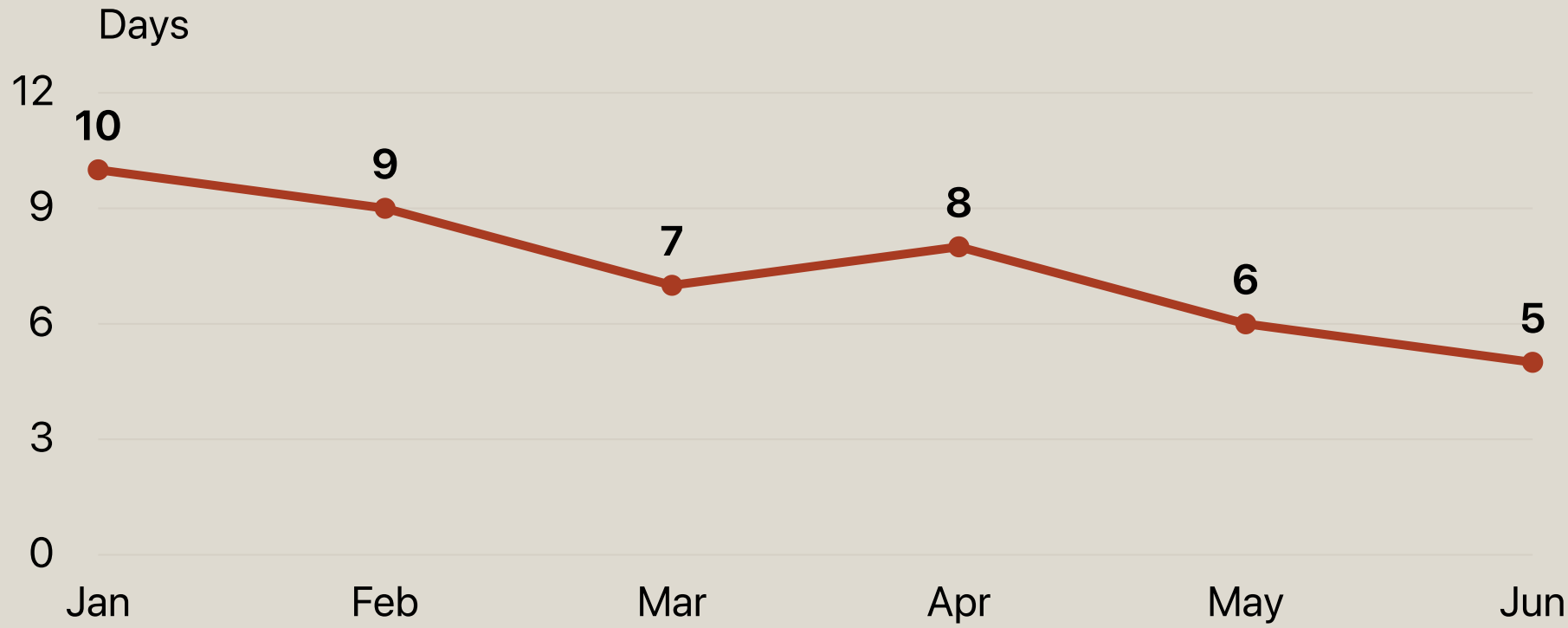
Build and Compliance are independent prerequisites for Launch. Spacing does not represent duration. · Fictional service-launch data · layout examples only

Read directed dependencies guidance ↗

TIME SERIES

How did onboarding time change?

Monthly average · days · 20 completed onboardings per cohort · 2026



Works well when

Use a line when supplied observations track one consistently defined measure over time and the audience asks about change.

Limitation

Poor fit for an unmeasured process sequence, missing observations joined as if measured, or a question about only two points.

Monthly means; consistent measure. April rises before the decline continues. Causes and within-cohort variation are unknown. · Fictional service-launch data · layout examples only

Read time series guidance ↗

ASYMMETRIC COMPOSITION

What launch date should the team plan around?

PLANNED LAUNCH

18 June 2027

Condition

Security review due 10 June 2027.

Planned, not confirmed.

Works well when

Use unequal fields when the brief supports one primary message and a smaller adjacent field can keep its qualification visible.

Limitation

Poor fit when claims have equal importance or the secondary field cannot remain legible.

Planned, not confirmed. Security review due 10 June 2027. Fictional planning data; the condition qualifies the date. · Fictional service-launch data · layout examples only

Read asymmetric composition guidance ↗